

ACADEMIC DISCIPLINE REVIEW TEMPLATE



Discipline Name: Click here to enter text.

Department: Click here to enter text.

Date: Click here to enter text.

Department Chair: Click here to enter text.

Completed By: Click here to enter text.

OVERVIEW OF THE DISCIPLINE REVIEW

THE MISSION

Jackson College (JC) is an institution of higher education whose mission is “Together we inspire and transform lives.” In fulfilling its mission, Jackson College provides learning opportunities and services which:

- Enable learners to transfer college credit and successfully pursue their education at other institutions.
- Enable learners to become employed and advance in a variety of occupations.
- Enable learners to participate successfully in general, occupational or transfer disciplines.
- Enable learners to become or remain productive employees.
- Assist learners in identifying and reaching their educational goals.
- Support the economic development of individuals and the community.
- Enrich cultural, vocational, and other intellectual interests of individuals and the community.

PHILOSOPHY

As an institution accredited by the Higher Learning Commission (HLC) that strives for continuous quality improvement (CQI), JC uses regularly scheduled discipline review as a tool to assess disciplines in terms of relevance, effectiveness and meeting stakeholder needs.

PURPOSE OF THE REVIEW

To determine that a discipline meets the current and future needs of students and external stakeholders, and that it has academic integrity, the findings are used for:

- Discipline planning
- Decision-making for improvement
- Revision of discipline goals
- Resource allocation and budget requests
- Reporting discipline progress and results to appropriate audiences

STRUCTURE

This template combines requirements for the Discipline Review. Each discipline has a review scheduled every five years which is presented at the Academic Council during the academic year. The discipline review timetable is posted on the faculty page on the JC Intranet.

GATHERING INFORMATION

- Collect and review data that document specific aspects of the discipline.
- Data may be quantitative or qualitative, direct, or indirect; may include performance indicators such as billing contact hours and may take the form of surveys. Certain elements must be quantitative.
- Feedback from stakeholders must be gathered.
- It is best to use multiple sources of evidence.

PROCEDURE

PRE-PLANNING

- All Course Reviews should be brought up to date in accordance with the discipline review timeline.
- Review the timeframes for completion of each step of the review.

MILESTONE CHECKPOINTS

- Schedule Data Analysis meeting with IRE
 - Identify any additional data that is needed and request those not already provided from sources.
- Connect with your Dean regarding feedback
- Finalize action projects and revise any other portions of the review as identified.
- Schedule meeting with Program and Pathway Committee for review of materials
 - DRAFT submitted to Program and Pathway Committee **TWO** months prior to AC presentation
 - FINAL Review and AC Presentation (found on the Faculty Page of the JC Intranet) submitted to Program and Pathway Committee **ONE** month prior to AC Presentation.

PRESENTATION OF REPORT TO ACADEMIC COUNCIL (AC)

- Pending Program and Pathway Committee approval confirm presentation date to AC.
- Discipline Review will be saved on the JC Intranet under Faculty.

FOLLOW UP

- Submit action plan update to Program and Pathway Committee one year from presentation.

SECTION 1: EDUCATION PROGRAMS (HLC CRITERION 3A)

Ensuring programs align with the institution's mission, vision, strategic priorities, and academic master plan.

1. Provide a narrative showing how courses align with the institution's mission.
2. Transferability, articulation agreements.
If Applicable, please explain or attach documents appendix.

SECTION 2: SUFFICIENCY OF FACULTY AND STAFF (HLC CRITERION 3C)

1. What is the current number of full-time and adjunct faculty in the discipline, and what are the percentages of these in terms of BCH?
2. Based on the above data, what needs do you anticipate in the future for staffing?
3. How do you build a qualified adjunct pool? Discuss any known barriers and solutions to those barriers.

SECTION 3: SUPPORT FOR STUDENT LEARNING AND RESOURCES FOR TEACHING. (HCL CRITERION 3D)

1. For each course in this discipline, look at enrollment trends over the last five years. Include both student enrollment and billing contact hours. (*provided by Institutional Research and Effectiveness*)
2. What discipline level trends are observed?
3. Based on enrollment data and the needs of the College, do you anticipate significant changes in the next five years? Why or why not?
4. Does the discipline have the necessary budgetary, human instructional, physical, and technological resources to demonstrate achievement of the mission, goals, and expected outcomes? Challenges/needs in future years? Anticipated department equipment, supplies, space needs? (Yes/No)

If no, list any current or new needs anticipated in the next five years for major equipment, technology, and supplies used by courses in the discipline.

Course	Equipment/Major Annual Supply Outlays	Campus/Center Location
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SECTION 4: ASSESSMENT OF STUDENT LEARNING (HLC CRITERION 3E)

Course Review Compliance: Because most of the analysis of individual courses takes place in the Curriculum Committee's Course Review Process, it is not necessary to duplicate that work. The Curriculum Committee must have reviewed all courses in this discipline within the last five years.

1. Do all the courses in the discipline have up to date course reviews filed with the curriculum committee? (Yes/No)
2. What discipline level trends can be observed across transfer institutions as you look at the transferability of individual courses? What changes are recommended based on this analysis?
3. Discuss strategies used to ensure consistency between courses in the discipline. (i.e., textbooks, master shell, syllabi, exams, adjunct coordination, technology, etc.).
4. For general education courses only:
 - Are the specific assessments in the individual courses for GEO compliance comparable in scope and magnitude?
 - If there are significant differences, what are your plans to address those differences?
5. What courses are currently being developed as CBE, and which ones already exist as CBE?
6. What are the benchmarks for students learning in each course in discipline?
7. What are the outcomes of those student learning benchmarks over the last 5 years?
8. Identify and discuss areas of improvement that are needed.
9. Provide evidence of student learning across assessments.

SECTION 5A: TRANSFER PARTNERS

1. When looking at all courses transferability, were trends found in terms of gaps at specific institutions and/or disciplines?
2. Comment on possible solutions to the lack of transferability.

SECTION 5B: ENROLLMENT TRENDS

Program/Certificate Enrollment Trends (Complete this table for each Program/Certificate included in the review).

5-year trend in enrollment/completion graph – disaggregated by student type.

SECTION 6: EXECUTIVE SUMMARY AND ACTION PROJECT

***THIS SECTION IS INCLUDED INTO YOUR PRESENTATION TO THE ACADEMIC COUNCIL.**

- A. Based on the data and your section summaries and analyses of observations, provide an Executive Summary/overview of the discipline. (A SWOT analysis that details the discipline's Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats may be included but is not required.)
- B. Based on the data and the Executive Summary, discuss and emphasize continuous quality enhancement, including recommendations for ongoing improvement, goals for future development (e.g., new initiatives, addressing emerging trends, curriculum updates), and plans to maintain current strengths.
 - Link action project(s) to the mission, vision and goals for the discipline.
 - Set reasonable timeframes and deadlines. Consider short-term project(s) (1-3 years) as well as long-term project(s) (3-5 years).
 - Be as specific as possible about who does what.
 - Include clearly defined methods of measuring progress.
 - Identify any resources required to implement the project(s).